

Crm Setup Checklist For Cold Calling Campaigns

Free cold-calling resource from Televista

A step-by-step guide to configuring your CRM for maximum cold calling efficiency. Works with GoHighLevel, HubSpot, Salesforce, Podio, REI BlackBook, Follow Up Boss, or any customizable CRM.

1. PIPELINE STAGES

Set up a dedicated cold calling pipeline with these stages:

- [] New Lead — Raw contact, not yet called*
- [] Attempted Contact — Called but no answer (track attempt count)*
- [] Contacted — Spoke with lead, pending qualification*
- [] Qualified — Meets your criteria, appointment needed*
- [] Appointment Set — Meeting scheduled*
- [] Appointment Completed — Met or presented to the lead*
- [] Proposal / Offer Made — Active negotiation*
- [] Under Contract — Deal in progress*
- [] Closed Won — Deal completed*
- [] Closed Lost — Deal did not close (tag the reason)*
- [] Dead Lead — Wrong number, deceased, do-not-call request*
- [] Nurture / Long-Term — Not ready now, follow up in 3-6 months*

TIP: Keep your pipeline under 12 stages. More than that creates confusion and leads get stuck.

2. CUSTOM FIELDS FOR COLD CALLING

Add these fields to every lead record:

- [] Lead Source (dropdown: list name, skip trace source, marketing channel)*
- [] List/Campaign Name (text: which specific list this lead came from)*
- [] Motivation Level (dropdown: 1-Hot, 2-Warm, 3-Cold, 4-No Motivation)*
- [] Property Condition (dropdown: Excellent, Good, Fair, Poor, Vacant/Distressed)*
- [] Timeline to Sell/Buy (dropdown: Immediate, 1-3 Months, 3-6 Months, 6+ Months, Unknown)*
- [] Asking Price (currency)*
- [] Estimated Value (currency)*
- [] Mortgage Balance (currency)*
- [] Property Type (dropdown: SFH, Multi-Family, Condo, Land, Commercial)*
- [] Occupancy Status (dropdown: Owner-Occupied, Tenant-Occupied, Vacant)*
- [] Number of Call Attempts (auto-increment or manual number)*
- [] Last Call Date (date)*
- [] Last Call Outcome (dropdown: No Answer, Left VM, Spoke - Interested, Spoke - Not Interested, Wrong Number, DNC Request)*

- [] Best Time to Call (dropdown: Morning, Afternoon, Evening)*
- [] Call Notes (long text)*
- [] Assigned Caller (team member dropdown)*
- [] Follow-Up Date (date)*
- [] Do Not Call (checkbox)*

3. LEAD SOURCE TRACKING

- [] Create a unique lead source tag for every list and campaign*
- [] Examples: "Skip Trace - Absentee Owners - March 2026", "Driving for Dollars - Phoenix", "Aged Internet Lead - Solar"*
- [] Tag leads on import — never import without a source tag*
- [] Build a report that shows cost per lead and conversion rate by source*
- [] Review monthly: kill sources under 1% conversion, double down on sources above 3%*

4. AUTOMATION RULES

Set up these automations to eliminate manual work:

- [] New Lead Notification — Instant alert (SMS or app notification) when a new lead enters the pipeline*
- [] Auto-Assign — Round-robin new leads to available callers based on capacity or territory*
- [] Missed Call Follow-Up — If lead calls back and no one answers, trigger an auto-text: "Hey [First Name], sorry I missed your call. I'll call you back within the hour."*
- [] Voicemail Drop Trigger — After 3 no-answers, automatically send a pre-recorded voicemail or SMS*
- [] Follow-Up Sequence — After first contact, trigger a 5-touch sequence:
Day 1: Call + SMS
Day 3: Call
Day 5: SMS
Day 7: Call + Email
Day 14: Call + SMS*
- [] Stale Lead Alert — If a lead in "Contacted" or "Qualified" stage has no activity for 7 days, alert the assigned caller*
- [] Appointment Reminder — Automated text/email 24 hours and 1 hour before appointment*
- [] DNC Auto-Remove — When "Do Not Call" checkbox is checked, automatically move to Dead Lead stage and exclude from all future campaigns*
- [] Re-Engagement — Leads in "Nurture" stage get an automated monthly touchpoint (email or text)*

5. DIALER INTEGRATION

- [] Connect your dialer (Mojo, BatchDialer, PhoneBurner, ReadyMode, etc.) to your CRM via native integration or Zapier*
- [] Ensure call outcomes sync back to CRM automatically*
- [] Map dialer dispositions to CRM stage changes:*
 - No Answer -> increment call attempt, keep in "Attempted Contact"*
 - Left VM -> increment attempt, add "Left VM" note*
 - Interested -> move to "Qualified", trigger appointment workflow*
 - Not Interested -> move to "Nurture" or "Dead Lead"*
 - Wrong Number -> move to "Dead Lead", tag "Bad Data"*
 - DNC Request -> trigger DNC automation*
- [] Set up call recording storage linked to each lead record*
- [] Enable screen-pop so caller sees lead info before they answer*

6. REPORTING DASHBOARDS

Build these reports and review them weekly:

- [] Call Volume — Total calls, connects, and talk time per caller per day*
- [] Connection Rate — Calls-to-conversations ratio (target: 8-12%)*
- [] Appointment Set Rate — Conversations-to-appointments (target: 15-25%)*
- [] Appointment Show Rate — Appointments set vs. completed (target: 70%+)*
- [] Cost Per Appointment — Total campaign cost / appointments set*
- [] Pipeline Value — Total estimated deal value by stage*
- [] Lead Source ROI — Revenue generated per dollar spent, by source*
- [] Caller Leaderboard — Ranked by appointments set, not just call volume*
- [] Stale Lead Report — Leads with no activity in 7+ days*
- [] DNC Compliance Report — All DNC requests logged with date and method*

7. TEAM PERMISSIONS

- [] Callers: Can view and edit their assigned leads only. Cannot delete leads or export data. Can log calls and set appointments.*
- [] Team Leads: Can view all leads in their team. Can reassign leads. Can view team reports but not individual compensation data.*
- [] Managers: Full access to all leads, reports, and settings. Can create/modify automations and import/export data.*
- [] Admin: Full system access including billing, integrations, and user management. Limit to 1-2 people.*
- [] Set up audit logging so you can see who changed what and when*
- [] Disable bulk export for all roles except Admin to protect your data*

FINAL TIPS

- Clean your data before importing. Remove duplicates, scrub against DNC lists, and validate phone numbers.
- Run a CRM audit every 30 days. Archive dead leads, update stale

stages, and check that automations are firing correctly.

- Your CRM is only as good as the data your team puts in. Enforce mandatory fields on disposition and make call notes a requirement, not an option.

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